Delhi as assistant commissioner, income tax, to inform him about vandalism taking place not very far from his house in J Block, Saket. Confirming the presence of about fifty hooligans not very far from his house, Gunjit was surprised how I had come to know about it. Appreciating my concern for his safety, he said the station house officer (SHO) at the Saket police station was known to them and he had assured them that no harm would come to them.

Later, on the intervening night of 1 and 2 November, policemen on duty at Dhaula Kuan crossing informed the control room that some hooligans were forcibly taking eight young Sikh girls towards a forested area of the nearby Ridge. They sought orders as to how to handle the situation. The caller used the word 'bhaisein' (buffalos) for the Sikh girls. The response from their control room was that the police force deployed there need not worry about them as the 'saands' (bulls) chasing them would take care of them.

Around the same time, policemen from Defence Colony started making frantic calls to the control room, informing them about the movement of an army vehicle carrying Sikh soldiers in that area. It appeared that a senior retired Sikh officer living in Defence Colony had sought help from the army unit stationed in the cantonment for his safety. Soon after, frantic messages started flowing in and out of the control room to ascertain who had sent the troops and under whose orders. That was the only time I witnessed the control room exhibit concern and urgency in dealing with a call received from the local police. The control room saw to it that the troops returned to their base as soon as possible.

Repeated calls the same night, over a period of a couple of hours, were received by the control room from policemen on duty at Tughlakabad railway station. According to them, a large crowd had gathered there and had planned to stop, even by tampering with the signals, trains arriving or passing through that station and going towards Delhi. It seemed they planned to kill Sikhs travelling on the trains. As the local police force was heavily outnumbered, they asked for reinforcements. They fetched no response from the control room. Very soon, they began informing the control room about the stopping of trains and killing of Sikh passengers by hooligans. Still there was no response.